

# Workplace Relationship/Affair Policy

## **Purpose:**

Workplace affair policy, also known as relationship policies, **address romantic or sexual relationships between employees, often including rules about disclosure, conduct, and potential conflicts of interest.** This policy aim to protect employees, maintain a professional environment and decorum of the Company, and prevent potential legal issues.

## **Scope:**

This policy covers relationships between employees and relationships between managers and employees, including appropriate and inappropriate workplace relationships and behaviours.

## **Policy details:**

We understand that workplace relationships do occur, and we do not prohibit relationships between employees from different departments or between employees at the same professional level. All employees should always behave professionally and refrain from discussing personal matters in the workplace. Employees should not engage in any behaviour that is distracting, disruptive or counter to our company's values and culture. Relationships between managers and direct reports is strictly prohibited.

## **Key aspects of workplace affair policies:**

- **Disclosure:** Employees will disclose any romantic or sexual relationships with co-workers, particularly those in supervisory roles or with direct reports. This can help prevent conflicts of interest and ensure a fair and equitable work environment.
- **Confidentiality:** We encourage reporting of workplace relationships in strict confidence, to protect the privacy of those involved.
- **Conduct:** The policy outline appropriate behaviour, such as avoiding excessive or inappropriate displays of affection, using office resources for personal relationships, or engaging in behaviour that could be perceived as harassment or intimidation.
- **Conflict of interest:** Policies may prohibit relationships between employees in different hierarchical levels or those who have a direct supervisory relationship, to prevent potential bias or unfairness.

- **Potential consequences:** Violations of workplace affair policies can result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination, depending on the severity of the violation and company policy.
- **Legal considerations:** While no law prohibits consensual relationships between employees, companies may have a legal obligation to maintain a work environment free from harassment or discrimination. Workplace affair policies can help companies mitigate legal risks associated with consensual relationships.
- **Employee education:** Companies should regularly educate employees about workplace relationship policies and the potential consequences of violating them.
- **Fairness and equity:** Workplace affair policies should be applied fairly and consistently to all employees, regardless of their marital status or relationship type.
- **Sensitivity and professionalism:** Companies should approach the topic of workplace relationships with sensitivity and professionalism, recognizing that these relationships can be complex and may have a significant impact on employee well-being and workplace dynamics.

### **Our Company's Commitment about Relationships in the Workplace**

- The policy is applicable to all employees.
- Everyone will be treated equally while taking appropriate decisions without discriminating against any individuals or both.
- Victimization, conflict and retaliation of any kind will be prohibited.
- Each case will be examined separately, and all aspects and perspectives will be considered before making decisions.
- Equal employment opportunity policy will be always followed. For example, we will not penalize a homosexual couple differently than a heterosexual couple when they both have violated our employee relationships policy in the same manner.

### **Special Circumstance and Exception**

Any Deviation from this policy has to be approved by HR. Any changes to the policy has to be approved by Legal and Compliance.

### **Non-compliance and Consequence**

Employees and co-workers maintaining relationships without informing their individual Managers or HR will be seriously viewed by the management as a violation of this policy and appropriate steps that will impact either or both parties will be initiated by HR.